

ELEKTRA

Assassin-for-hire

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FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Elektra Natchios

OCCUPATION

Mercenary assassin

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

5 ft 9 in

WEIGHT

130 lbs

EYES

Blue-Black

HAIR

Black

FIRST APPEARANCE

Daredevil Vol. 1 #168

(January 1981)

POWERS

Awesome martial arts skills, particularly proficient in Ninjutsu; skilled with martial art weaponry, especially the sai; Olympic-standard gymnast and athlete; limited telepathic abilities and partial control of nervous system.



From their first encounter, Elektra's fate was bound to Matt Murdock's.

The histories of so many superpowered individuals are marred by tragedy. While in some cases these tragedies drive them towards heroism others are compelled to pursue careers of villainy. For Elektra Natchios this choice has never been clear-cut—while she continues to yearn for contentment, time and again her happiness has been spoiled by the intervention of others.

ETCHED BY SADNESS

Even before she was born, misfortune was etched into Elektra's existence: her mother was shot while pregnant and died soon after giving birth. When Elektra's overprotective father became Greek ambassador to the US, she enrolled at Columbia University in New York City, but was followed everywhere by security guards.

Despite this restriction, a romance grew between Elektra and Matt Murdock, a fellow student. For a year, a clandestine relationship flourished, but when her father was killed during a hostage incident Elektra's whole world fell apart.

Riven with grief she fled, leaving Matt and the US behind.



Elektra was not the first to be resurrected by the Hand. That fate fell to 16th-century warrior, Eliza Martinez.

KILLER FOR HIRE

Elektra trained as a Ninja and for a year belonged to the Chaste, a Ninja order led by Matt Murdock's own mentor, Stick. Elektra's "impure" heart stopped her joining the Chaste and this rejection drove her to the Chaste's enemy—the HAND, an order of assassins. Elektra abandoned them and became an assassin for hire. This ironically led her back to Matt, now also the crime-fighter DAREDEVIL. Once lovers, they were now opponents but despite this, when



Fatally injured, Elektra crawls to Matt's apartment to die.

Elektra was mortally wounded by BULLSEYE, it was to Matt's door that she crawled and in his arms that she died. Matt refused to believe Elektra was dead and became involved in the Hand's attempt to resurrect her. While Matt failed to prevent her return, his love purified her soul, making her useless to the Hand.

ELEKTRA REBORN

Recently, Elektra appeared to have rejoined the Hand to battle the AVENGERS. However, when she was killed, the Avengers discovered she was a SKRULL imposter—a fact they'd been unable to detect before. This heralded the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7) during which the original Elektra escaped from the Skrulls and returned to her life. AD, MF

KEY STORYLINES

• Daredevil #168-9

Elektra's first encounter with Matt Murdock; her origin is revealed.

• Daredevil #174-181

Elektra fights the Hand with Matt, is recruited by the Kingpin, and dies at the hands of Bullseye.

• Daredevil #190

Elektra is reborn and more about her past is revealed.

• Elektra Vol. 2 #11-15

As her addiction to violence reaches new heights, relatives of Elektra's victims seek revenge.

Armed with her trademark sai, few have stood against Elektra and survived.

Following her resurrection, a purified Elektra fought evil, garbed in a white costume.